



INPUT DEVICES (GENERAL)

The keyboard of the Microsoft Wireless Optical Desktop has the characters etched in white over the translucent black keys, producing excellent contrast. The scroll wheel allows for horizontal as well as vertical scrolling. The keyboard comes with hot keys for folders, as well as multimedia keys, apart from five programmable keys. It has a soft un-detachable palm rest with a smooth leather finish.

The optical mouse comes with Microsoft's new Tilt technology that allows scrolling in both horizontal and vertical directions. This feature is a great help if you work with Excel, or DTP software, where horizontal scroll is a boon. The mouse is designed for right-handed people, with contoured grooves that result in stress-free usage. The scroll wheel is too smooth, and lacks tactile feel when used in games for switching weapons—or maybe we are too used to the click of a Logitech scroll wheel. The mouse is extremely precise and is not plagued with the line of sight problem, because it uses RF. The combination requires Five AA batteries—three for the keyboard and two for the mouse. The soft-

Microsoft Wireless Optical Desktop Elite

+ Works on RF, horizontal plus vertical scrolling, 5-button mouse

– Designed for right-handers, lacks tactile feel

Price: Rs 7,250

Contact: Microsoft Corporation India

Phone: 1600-111 100

Fax: 011-2642 8540

E-mail: connect

@microsoft.com

Reviewed in:

October 2003



PREVIOUS WINNERS

2002: Logitech Cordless Freedom Optical Keyboard (Keyboard), Microsoft Wireless IntelliMouse Explorer (Mouse)

2001: Logitech Cordless Freedom Navigator (Keyboard), Logitech Cordless MouseMan Wheel (Mouse)

ware provided shows the battery status and the wireless signal quality.

The Microsoft Wireless Optical Desktop Elite is priced at Rs 7,250 and comes with a

WORTHY MENTIONS

Microsoft Multimedia Keyboard

+ Well designed and sturdy

– Expensive

Price: Rs 1,498

Contact: Microsoft Corporation India

Phone: 011-2629 2640

E-mail: connect@microsoft.com

Reviewed in: January 2003

Microsoft Wireless IntelliMouse Explorer

+ Optical Mouse, USB interface, 2 extra buttons, 2 AAA batteries

– Expensive

Price: Rs 4,278

Contact: Microsoft Corporation India Pvt Ltd

Phone: 011-5151 1234

Fax: 011-2629 2640

E-mail: connect@microsoft.com

Reviewed in: January 2003

3-year replacement warranty. Overall, a great product for your desktop if you can afford it; but gamers might want to stay away from this combo as it lacks that extra feel required for gaming.

MFDs

We tested MFDs in both the Inkjet and Laser categories. The Xerox WorkCentre Pro 412 is a top-of-the-range MFD solution for corporate users, and dwarfs all the others in features and performance alike.

The design is very traditional Xerox, and it looks like a full fledged copier. It's huge, and weighs 22 kg.

The feature list on the 412 is long and extensive: the paper loading cassette has a capacity of 650 pages. The printer unit supports a true resolution of 600 x 600. The scanner unit employs a CCD sensor and supports a true resolution of 600 x 600. The 35-pages Automatic Document Feeder simplifies scanning. The fax features 4 MB of memory that can store 400 pages of faxes, and can acquire a maximum modem speed of 33.6 kbps.

Performance was good in all departments. Printing was fast, and the quality was excellent. Both text and image scanning were fast. In the IT8 card tonal deviation test, the 412 demonstrated excellent colour repro-

Xerox WorkCentre Pro 412

+ Fast printing, excellent quality

– Expensive

Price: Rs 73,500

Contact: Xerox Modicorp Limited

Phone: 0124-2561 930/940

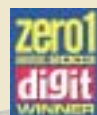
Fax: 0124-256 1255

E-mail: kuldeep.malho-

tra@ind.xerox.com

Reviewed in:

October 2003



PREVIOUS WINNERS

2002: NA

2001: NA

ducing capability. But in the colour deviation test for the lighter regions of the spectrum, the 412 performed badly. Resolution was average.

The 412 showed its true mettle in the copying test: where all the other MFDs took a minimum of 20 seconds, the 412 completed the job in just 12 seconds, and that, without any loss in quality.

WORTHY MENTIONS

Canon MP 730

+ Lots of features, easy to use, low running cost, best performance in prosumer category

– Bulky design

Price: Rs 34,995

Contact: Canon India Pvt Ltd

Phone: 011-2680 6572

Fax: 011-2680 7180

E-mail: rajeev.singh@canon.co.in

Reviewed in: October 2003

Lexmark X 5150

+ Good scanning, best value

– Bad printing quality, ink guzzler

Price: Rs 10,999

Contact: Lexmark International (India) Pvt Ltd

Phone: 022-2605 7755

Fax: 022-2605 4678

Email: sandeepk@lexmark.com

Reviewed In: October 2003

Although it's expensive, the WorkCentre Pro 412 makes up with features that'll meet the demands of most corporate offices.